



WYCOMBE
ABBEY

SAMPLE QUESTIONS
11+ Entrance Examination
English

Write your answers on A4 lined paper. Please write your name on each sheet of paper you use.

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Please read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow:

He had two other things to take along to the room with the dolls. He waited until after lunch. And he had to think of something to put them all in, too.

He looked about him carefully, on the landing and up the first flight of stairs. There was nobody. Anyway, if Hooper already knew about the room, it scarcely mattered now.

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All the doors up here were painted brown, and after the first landing, there was no carpet. Kingshaw thought, I hate this house, I hate it, it is the very worst of all the places we have lived in. From the first moment he had looked at it, out of the car window, he had hated it. It didn't seem much for Hooper to be so proud of.

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He walked along a little, dark passage-way, and turned into the corridor. Then he saw Hooper. He was sitting on the floor, with his back against the door of the room and his legs stretched out. Kingshaw stopped dead.

'Going somewhere?'

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'Get lost, Hooper.'

'Where's the key? Look, this isn't *your* house, you know, who do you think you are, going around locking doors?'

'Stuff it.'

'You can't come in here any more unless I say so.'

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Kingshaw put down the small box he was carrying, wearily. Hooper was very childish.

'You needn't think I'm going away, either. I can stay here all day. All night as well, if I like. I can stay here for ever. This is my house.'

'Why don't you grow up?'

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'I want to know what's in here.'

'Nothing.'

'That means something. You'd better tell me.'

'Shut up.'

'I want to know what you keep coming up here for. You needn't think I don't know where you go to, I've known for weeks, all the time, I've known.'

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Kingshaw was silent. He stood some way back from Hooper, his face in the shadows. There was the sound of rain on the roof. He might as well let Hooper in. He'd get in, anyway, fight, or else just stick it out for hours on end. He had no good opinion of his own chances, against Hooper. Or against anyone. He was not cowardly. Just realistic, hopeless. He did not give in to people, he only went, from the beginning, with the assurance that he would be beaten. It meant that there was no surprise, and no disappointment, about anything.

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So he might as well let Hooper into the room now, and get it over with. If he was going to find out, he might as well find out because Kingshaw chose to let him. It kept the initiative in his hands, somehow, and he cared about that. Hooper always won.

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Kingshaw reached slowly into the back pocket of his jeans, and fetched out the key.

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Questions:

1. Read the whole passage and then note down **three** things we learn about Kingshaw. [3 marks]
2. Look at the fourth paragraph (beginning 'He walked along a little...'). Identify **two verbs** used to describe how Hooper is behaving and write one sentence explaining what these words suggest. [3 marks]
3. **In your own words**, describe how Kingshaw and Hooper relate to one another. [4 marks]
4. Kingshaw does not seem to like being around Hooper. **Quoting evidence** from the text, **explain** how the writer creates this impression. [5 marks]
5. In this passage, Kingshaw has strong feelings about the place he is in. **Describe a place that you really like to be in or a place that you really do not like to be in.**

You will be marked on the quality of your writing and how successfully you communicate your ideas.

You are encouraged to take time to plan out your ideas before starting to write.

[10 marks]